

Word family: **recommend / recommends / recommended / recommending / recommendation / recommendations / recommendable**

Base word: recommend

Forms: recommends, recommended, recommending

Related forms: recommendation, recommendations, recommendable

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / related noun and adjective forms (相關名詞及形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “I first heard about it a few years ago when several friends kept **recommending** it to me...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **recommend** means **to tell someone that you think a person, book, product, place, action, etc. is good or suitable and worth choosing, trying, reading, visiting, or doing**.

繁體中文：***推薦；認為某人 / 某事物很好、合適或值得選擇，因此建議別人去試、去用、去看或去做**

中文翻譯：

> “...several friends kept **recommending** it to me...”

「.....有幾位朋友一直向我**推薦**這本書.....」

Here:

recommend a book to someone = 向某人推薦一本自己認為值得讀的書

1. **recommend = suggest something because you think it is good/suitable (推薦) — 推薦**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: To tell someone that you think a person, product, book, place, service, etc. is good, suitable, or worth choosing.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Several friends kept **recommending** the book to me.”

「有幾位朋友一直向我**推薦**這本書。」

Practice 2

> “Can you **recommend** a good restaurant?”

「你可以**推薦**一間好的餐廳嗎？」

Practice 3

> “I would highly **recommend** this course.”

「我會非常**推薦**這門課程。」

recommend = 根據自己的判斷，告訴別人某人 / 某事物值得選擇、使用或嘗試

Common:

- * recommend a book
- * recommend a restaurant
- * recommend a product
- * highly recommend
- * strongly recommend

2. **recommend** = advise a course of action (建議) — 建議；勸告

Recommend can also mean advising that someone should do something.

Practice 4

> “The doctor **recommended** more rest.”

「醫生**建議**多休息。」

Practice 5

> “I **recommend** taking the earlier train.”

「我**建議**乘搭較早的火車。」

recommend = 根據經驗、專業判斷或情況，建議採取某種做法

This is distinct from simply praising or endorsing a thing.

3. **recommend** = formally advise or propose something (正式建議) — 建議；提議

In professional, institutional, or official contexts, ****recommend**** can mean formally proposing a decision, policy, action, appointment, etc.

Practice 6

> “The committee ****recommended**** several changes.”

「委員會****建議****作出幾項修改。」

Practice 7

> “The report ****recommends**** further research.”

「報告****建議****進一步研究。」

****recommend** = 以較正式、專業或制度性的方式提出建議******

For strict counting, I would usually merge this with Meaning 2.

4. ****recommend** = put someone forward as suitable (推薦某人) — 推薦；舉薦******

****Recommend**** can mean suggesting that a particular person is suitable for a job, role, award, opportunity, etc.

Practice 8

> “She was ****recommended**** for promotion.”

「她獲****推薦****晉升。」

Practice 9

> “His manager ****recommended**** him for the position.”

「他的經理****推薦****他擔任這個職位。」

****recommend someone for something** = 認為某人適合某職位、機會或榮譽，因此加以推薦******

This is a useful distinct pattern.

5. ****recommend** = make something attractive or worthy (較正式) — 使值得考慮；使有吸引力

**

There is also a more formal use where a quality **recommends** someone or something.

Practice 10

> “His experience **recommends** him for the role.”

「他的經驗令他很**適合 / 值得考慮**這個職位。」

Practice 11

> “Its simplicity **recommends** it to beginners.”

「它的簡單易用令它很**適合推薦給**初學者。」

****recommend = 某種特點使某人 / 某物顯得合適、有吸引力或值得選擇****

This is established but more formal and less common in everyday English.

Related form: **recommendation**

****Recommendation**** has several important uses.

**recommendation = advice/suggestion (建議) **

Practice 12

> “The report makes several useful **recommendations**.”

「這份報告提出了幾項有用的**建議**。」

**recommendation = endorsement (推薦) **

Practice 13

> “I bought the book on a friend's **recommendation**.”

「我是因為朋友的**推薦**而買這本書的。」

**recommendation = formal reference/support (推薦信 / 推薦意見) **

Practice 14

> “She asked her professor for a **recommendation**.”

「她請教授為她提供一份**推薦信 / 推薦意見**。」

recommendation = 建議、推薦，或正式支持某人的推薦意見

Related form: **recommendable**

Recommendable means worth recommending or suitable to be recommended.

Practice 15

> “It is a highly **recommendable** introduction to the subject.”

「這是一本很**值得推薦的**入門書。」

This word is valid, but much less common than:

* highly recommended

* worth recommending

So it is lower priority.

Important distinction: **recommend** vs **suggest**

suggest

is broader and can introduce almost any idea or possibility.

recommend

usually implies a stronger judgment that something is good, suitable, or advisable.

> “I suggest leaving early.”

neutral idea.

> “I recommend leaving early.”

stronger advice.

Important distinction: **recommend vs advise**

advise

usually focuses on telling a person what they should do.

recommend

can recommend either:

- * a thing/person

- * an action

- > recommend a book

- > advise someone to rest

There is overlap in action advice.

Important distinction: **recommend vs endorse**

endorse

means publicly or officially support or approve something/someone.

recommend

is broader and more everyday.

- > recommend a restaurant

- > endorse a candidate/product

Endorse often sounds more formal or public.

Important distinction: **recommend vs propose**

propose

means put forward an idea or plan for consideration.

recommend

adds the judgment that the option is preferable or advisable.

> propose a new system

> recommend adopting the new system

Important distinction: ****recommend vs refer****

These are sometimes confused.

****recommend****

= say someone/something is good or suitable

****refer****

= direct someone to another person, service, source, etc.

> "I recommend this doctor."

= I think this doctor is good.

> "I'll refer you to this doctor."

= I will formally/directly send you to this doctor.

Grammar note: ****recommend something to someone****

Natural:

> "She recommended the book to me."

Also natural:

> "She recommended me a book."

This second pattern is used in some varieties of English, but the first is more broadly standard and safer for learners:

> ****recommend something to someone****

Grammar note: **recommend doing something**

Natural:

> “I recommend taking a taxi.”

Very common.

Grammar note: **recommend that + clause**

Natural:

> “I recommend that you leave early.”

Also:

> “I recommend that he apply again.”

In formal English, especially American English, the verb after **recommend that** often stays in the base form:

> “I recommend that she **be** informed.”

Grammar note: **recommend someone to do something**

This structure is much less preferred in standard modern English.

Better:

> “I recommend that you take a break.”

or:

> “I recommend taking a break.”

rather than:

> “I recommend you to take a break.” ❌/nonstandard in many varieties

This is an important learner point.

Countability note

****Recommendation**** is countable:

> a recommendation

> several recommendations

But in phrases like:

> on someone's recommendation

it behaves more abstractly.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* ****recommend****

* ****recommended****

* ****recommending****

* ****recommendation****

* ****recommendations****

* ****recommendable****

The key semantic split is between:

* ****endorsing a person/thing as good or suitable****

* ****advising a course of action****

Formal committee/report uses are best kept under the advice branch rather than split artificially.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
recommend — thing/person	認為某人 / 某物很好或合適，因此推薦給別人
recommend — action	根據判斷或經驗，建議採取某種做法
recommend — formal proposal	以較正式或專業方式提出建議；通常可併入 advice 義
recommend someone for something	認為某人適合某職位、機會或榮譽，因此加以推薦
recommend — formal quality sense	某種特點令某人 / 某物顯得值得考慮或選擇
recommendation	建議；推薦；正式推薦意見

| **commendable**

| 值得推薦的；較低頻

|

For your original sentence

> "...several friends kept **recommending** it to me..."

The exact meaning is:

recommend = 朋友認為這本書很好、值得讀，所以不斷叫我去讀

So:

> **recommend the book to me**

= **向我推薦這本書**

For your database, I would count **4 genuinely useful core meanings** for **recommend**:

1. **recommend a person/thing as good or suitable**
2. **advise a course of action**
3. **recommend someone for a role/opportunity**
4. **formal: a quality recommends someone/something = makes them suitable/worthy**

I would merge committee/report recommendations into #2, and keep **recommendation / commendable** as family extensions rather than inflate the verb count.